

Eduardo Montero

Harris School of Public Policy,
University of Chicago
1307 E 60th St., Chicago, IL 60637

Email: emontero@uchicago.edu
Website: www.eduardo-montero.com

Academic Positions

2021 –	University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy <i>Assistant Professor</i>
2022, 2019 – 2020	Harvard Academy for International and Area Studies <i>Postdoctoral Scholar</i>
2018 – 2021	University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy <i>Assistant Professor</i>

Affiliations

2021 –	Bureau for Research and Economic Analysis of Development (BREAD), <i>Affiliate</i>
2021 –	National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER), <i>Research Fellow (DEV)</i>

Education

2018	Harvard University <i>Ph.D., Economics</i>
2011	Stanford University <i>M.S., Statistics</i>
2010	Stanford University <i>B.A., Economics (with distinction)</i>

Research Fields

Development Economics, Political Economy, Economic History

Research Papers

“[The Legacy of Colonial Medicine in Central Africa](#),” with Sara Lowes, 2021. *American Economic Review*, 111(4): 1284-1314. [[Appendix](#).]

“[Concessions, Violence, and Indirect Rule: Evidence from the Congo Free State](#),” with Sara Lowes, 2021. *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 136(4): 2047-2091. [[Appendix](#).]

“[The Effects of Fair Trade Certification: Evidence From Coffee Producers in Costa Rica](#),” with Raluca Dragusanu and Nathan Nunn, 2022. *Journal of the European Economic Association*, 20(4): 1743-1790. [[Appendix](#).]

“[Religious Festivals and Economic Development: Evidence from the Timing of Mexican Saint Day Festivals](#),” with Dean Yang, 2022. *American Economic Review*, 112(10): 3176–3214. [[Appendix](#).]

“[Cooperative Property Rights and Development: Evidence from Land Reform in El Salvador](#),” 2022. *Journal of Political Economy*, 130(1): 48-93. [[Appendix](#). [Erratum](#).]

[“Market Structure and Extortion: Evidence from 50,000 Extortion Payments,”](#) with Zach Y. Brown, Carlos Schmidt-Padilla, and Maria Micaela Sviatschi, 2025. *Review of Economic Studies*, 92(3): 1595-1624.

[“The Price of Faith: Economic Costs and Religious Adaptation in Sub-Saharan Africa”](#) with Dean Yang and Triana Yentzen, 2026. Working Paper. *Revision Requested, Quarterly Journal of Economics*.

[“Culture, Policy, and Economic Development”](#) with Natalie Bau and Sara Lowes, 2025. Working Paper, Forthcoming in the *Handbook of Cultural Economics* (Eds. B. Enke, P. Giuliano, N. Nunn, and L. Wantchekon)

[“Religion in Emerging and Developing Regions”](#) with Ben Marx and Sara Lowes, 2025. Forthcoming in the *Annual Review of Economics*

[“Fallow Lengths and the Structure of Property Rights”](#) with Etienne Le Rossignol and Sara Lowes, 2026. Working Paper.

[“Age Sets, Accountability, and the Balance of Power: Evidence from Villages in Rural Congo”](#) with Sara Lowes, Nathan Nunn, and James A. Robinson, 2026. Working Paper.

[“Disease, Disparities, and Development: Evidence from Chagas Disease Control in Brazil”](#) with Jon Denton-Schneider, 2025. Working Paper.

Research In Progress

[“Resisting Social Death: African Origins of Development in the Colombian Pacific”](#) with Juan Sebastián Galán

[“Bokoko: Supernatural Authority and Political Power in the DRC”](#) with Sara Lowes, Nathan Nunn, and James A. Robinson

[“When Criminal Authority Fractures: Violence, Extortion, and the Consequences of Fragmentation in Ecuador’s Drug Trade”](#) with Martin Castillo Quintana, Camila Contreras, Natalia Guerrero, Endy Herrera, Mica Sviatschi, Luis Vinueza-Tarquino

Research Synopses for Broader Media

The Brazilian Report - [Disease Control is Good for Business](#) – March 2025

Becker Friedman Institute - [The Price of Faith: Economic Costs and Religious Adaptation in Sub-Saharan Africa](#) – March 2025

Becker Friedman Institute - [Disease, Disparities, and Development: Evidence from Chagas Disease Control in Brazil](#) – February 2025

Becker Friedman Institute - [Fallow Lengths and the Structure of Property Rights](#) – March 2024

African Economic History Network - [Historical Experiences and Demand for Health](#) – November 2021

NBER Digest - [Religious Festivals, Agriculture, and Economic Progress in Mexico](#) – August 2021

ProMarket - [Competition for Extortion: Evidence from 50,000 Extortion Payments in El Salvador](#) – February 2021

VoxDev - [Lasting Effects of Colonial-era Resource Exploitation in Congo](#) – January 2020

VoxDev - [Historical Experiences and Demand for Health](#) – June 2018

VoxEU - [Historical Experiences and Foreign Aid Efficacy](#) – May 2018

Book Chapters & Non-Refereed Publications

[“Traditional Medicine in Central Africa,”](#) with Sara Lowes, 2019, *American Economic Association Papers and Proceedings*, 109: 516-520.

[“King Leopold’s Ghost: The Legacy of Labor Coercion in the DRC,”](#) *The Long Economic Shadow of History*. Eds. Stelios Michalopoulos and Elias Papaioannou, CEPR/VOXEU, 2017, (with Sara Lowes)

Research Awards and Honors

AER Excellence in Reviewing Award 2025

Becker Friedman Institute Latin America-UNAB Grant 2025. “State Security Policies and the Dynamics of Extortion in Ecuador” (with Felipe Balmaceda and Martin Castillo-Quintana)

Becker Friedman Institute Socioeconomic Inequalities Initiative Grant 2025. “Reducing Inequalities Through Disease Control: The Socioeconomic Impacts of Wolbachia Deployment Against Aedes-borne Diseases in Brazil” (with Jon Denton Schneider)

Becker Friedman Institute Latin America-INSPIRE Grant 2025. “Reducing Inequalities Through Disease Control: The Socioeconomic Impacts of Wolbachia Deployment Against Aedes-borne Diseases in Brazil” (with Jon Denton Schneider)

Becker Friedman Institute Latin America-INSPIRE Grant 2024. “Disease, Disparities, and Development: Evidence from Chagas Disease Control in Brazil” (with Jon Denton Schneider)

Becker Friedman Institute, Political Economics Initiative Research Grant, 2023. “African Origins of Development in the Colombian Pacific,” (with Juan Sebastián Galán)

Becker Friedman Institute, Research Grants for the Study of Economics in Brazil, 2022. “Health, Income, and Public Finances in a Developing Economy: Evidence from Chagas Disease Eradication in Brazil,” (with Jon Denton Schneider)

Teaching Honor Roll, 2021. Ford School PubPol 534 & PubPol 750.001

Pershing Square Venture Fund for Research on the Foundations of Human Behavior, 2020. “Age Organization and Accountability: Evidence from the DRC,” (with Sara Lowes, Nathan Nunn, and James A. Robinson).

Harvard Academy Research Grant, Harvard University, 2020.

Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning, 2018.

Roger L. Martin Cornerstone Graduate Student Fellowship, Harvard University, 2017.

DFID RA4 Grant, 2017. “Age Organization and Accountability: Evidence from the DRC,” (with Sara Lowes, Nathan Nunn, and James A. Robinson).

Cambridge University Press Dissertation Fellowship, Economic History Association, 2016.

J-PAL Governance Initiative, 2016. “Age Organization and Accountability: Evidence from the DRC,” (with Sara Lowes, Nathan Nunn, and James A. Robinson).

Weiss Family Program Fund Grant, 2016. “Addressing Mistrust in Medicine in Central Africa,” (with Sara Lowes).

Warburg Fund Grant, 2016. “Land Redistribution and Incomplete Property Rights: Evidence from Land Lotteries in Puerto Rico,” (with Raissa Fabregas).

Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning, 2015.

Institute for Quantitative Social Science Grant, 2015. “Blood Rubber: The Effects of Labor Coercion on Development and Culture in the DRC” (with Sara Lowes)

Warburg Fund Grant, 2015. “Blood Rubber: The Effects of Labor Coercion on Development and Culture in the DRC,” (with Sara Lowes).

The History Project Research Grant, Center for History and Economics, 2015. “Blood Rubber: The Effects of Labor Coercion on Development and Culture in the DRC” (with Sara Lowes)

Private Enterprise Development in Low-Income Countries Grant. 2015. “The Impacts of Currency Fluctuations on Ethiopian Firms,” (with Alex Segura).

Lab for Economic Applications and Policy Grant (LEAP) Research Grant, 2015. “Blood Rubber: The Effects of Labor Coercion on Development and Culture in the DRC” (with Sara Lowes)

Foundations of Human Behavior Initiative Summer Research Grant, 2014. "Blood Rubber: The Effects of Labor Coercion on Development and Culture in the DRC" (with Sara Lowes)

Graduate Research and Travel Grant, 2014, 2016. "Cooperative Property Rights and Agricultural Development: Evidence from Land Reform in El Salvador."

Lab for Economic Applications and Policy Grant (LEAP) Research Grant, 2013. "The Lasting Impacts of Colonial Medical Campaigns in Central Africa" (with Sara Lowes)

Douglas Dillon Fellow, Harvard University, 2012-2013.

Professional Activities

Editorial Service: *Journal of the European Economic Association*, Associate Editor

Referee: *American Economic Review*, *AER: Insights*, *AEJ: Applied*, *AEJ: Policy*, *American Political Science Review*, *Econometrica*, *Economic Journal*, *Explorations in Economic History*, *Journal of Comparative Economics*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *Journal of Economic Growth*, *Journal of Economic History*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Journal of Law, Economics and Organization*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Journal of Politics*, *National Science Foundation*, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Review of Economic Studies*

Dissertation Committees (Initial Placement): [Jon Denton-Schneider](#) (Clark University)

Dissertation Committees (Initial Placement): [Natalia Guerrero Trinidad](#) (Universidad de Los Andes)

Dissertation Committees (Initial Placement): [Pedro Magaña Saenz](#) (Nclusion)

Dissertation Committees (Initial Placement): [Daniel Sonnenstuhl](#) (Nclusion)

Seminar and Conference Presentations

"The Price of Faith: Economic Costs and Religious Adaptation in Sub-Saharan Africa":

Harvard-MIT Development Economics Seminar (February 2026), Lund University (October 2025), Northwestern Econ (February 2025), Berkeley ARE (November 2024), Aix-Marseille (November 2024), Toulouse School of Economics (November 2024), Paris School of Economics (November 2024), University of Namur (November 2024), Gottingen University (October 2024), University of British Columbia (October 2024)

"Age Sets, Accountability, and the Balance of Power: Evidence from Villages in Rural Congo":

Copenhagen (October 2025)

"Disease, Disparities, and Development: Evidence from Chagas Disease Control in Brazil":

BFI-INSPIRE Sao Paulo Conference (October 2025), NOVAfrica Conference (June 2024), Michigan MDev Conference (May 2024), USC (April 2024), PUC-Chile (September 2023), Inter-American Development Bank (June 2023)

"Fallow Lengths and the Structure of Property Rights":

IFPRI (November 2026), Society for Personality & Social Psychology (SPSP) Conference (February 2025), Stanford University (June 2024), World Bank Land Conference (May 2024), NBER Development Economics Meeting (December 2023), George Mason University (October 2022), NOVAFRICA Conference (June 2022)

"Market Structure and Extortion: Evidence from 50,000 Extortion Payments":

Columbia University (December 2022), ESPOL (November 2022), University of Maryland (November 2022), Notre Dame (October 2022), University of Wisconsin (October 2022), World Bank ABCDE Conference (June 2022), Harvard Academy (March 2022), Paris Sorbonne (November 2021), Universidad de Costa Rica (October 2021), SIOE (June 2021), BREAD (May 2021), Harvard Business School BGIE Seminar (October 2020), LANE-HOPE Seminar (Universidad de Los Andes, October 2020)

“Religious Festivals and Economic Development: Evidence from the Timing of Mexican Saint Day Festivals”:

Brown University (December 2021), University of Washington (November 2021), CEPR Workshop in Political Economy, Cultural Economics and Gender (June 2021), University of Nottingham (March 2021), Vancouver School of Economics (March 2021), RIDGE: Towards Sustainable Growth Workshop (December 2020), NBER Development Economics Meeting (November 2020), ASREC24hr Conference (November 2020), SIOE Conference (June 2020), University of Michigan H2D2 Conference (March 2020), ASREC Conference (March 2020), University of Michigan Political Economy Seminar (November 2019)

“Cooperative Property Rights and Agricultural Development: Evidence from Land Reform in El Salvador”:

Economics of Social Sector Organizations (Chicago, October 2020), NBER Organizations (Cambridge, April 2020), Harvard LACLAS Seminar (Cambridge, October 2019), Dartmouth Economics (Dartmouth, October 2019), LACEA-LAMES Conference (Guayaquil, Ecuador, November 2018), Northwestern Development Rookiefest (Chicago, IL, May 2018), Stanford University (Palo Alto, CA, May 2018), EHA Conference (San Jose, CA, September 2017)

“The Legacy of Colonial Medicine in Central Africa”:

University of Michigan Economic History Seminar (Ann Arbor, MI, April 2019), University of Michigan Economic Development Seminar (Ann Arbor, MI, April, 2019), Deep Rooted Factors in Comparative Development (Brown, RI, May 2018)

“Concessions, Violence, and Indirect Rule: Evidence from the Congo Free State”:

NBER Economics of Culture and Institutions Spring Meeting (Cambridge, MA, April 2018), Deep Rooted Factors in Comparative Development (Brown, RI, May 2017); WGAPE (World Bank, DC, April 2016); Conference Sur la Croissance Economique Inclusive en RDC (Kinshasa, DRC, January 2015); B-WGAPE (Cambridge, MA, November 2014); NEUDC (Boston University, MA, October 2014); Macro Lunch (Brown, RI, September 2014)

Teaching

University of Chicago:

Spring 2026	PPHA 41120: PhD Political Economy of Development (PhD)
Spring 2026	PPHA 35550: Economic Development and Policy (Graduate)
Spring 2026	PPHA 25550: Economic Development and Policy (Undergraduate)
Spring 2025	PPHA 41120: PhD Political Economy of Development w/ Raul Sanchez de la Sierra
Spring 2025	PPHA 35550: Economic Development and Policy (Graduate)
Spring 2025	PPHA 25550: Economic Development and Policy (Undergraduate)
Spring 2024	PPHA 41120: PhD Political Economy of Development w/ Raul Sanchez de la Sierra
Spring 2024	PPHA 35550: Economic Development and Policy (Graduate)
Spring 2024	PPHA 25550: Economic Development and Policy (Undergraduate)
Spring 2023	PPHA 41120: PhD Political Economy of Development w/ Chris Blattman
Spring 2023	PPHA 35550: Economic Development and Policy (Graduate)

University of Michigan:

Winter 2021	Econ 666: PhD Development Economics II w/ Yussuf Neggers
Winter 2021	PubPol 750.001: Applied Methods for Development (Graduate)
Winter 2021	PubPol 534: Economics of Developing Countries (Graduate)
Winter 2019	PubPol 750.310: Applied Methods for Development (Graduate)
Winter 2019	PubPol 480.001: Global Policy Seminar: Costa Rica (Undergraduate)
Winter 2019	PubPol 558.001: Microeconomics B (Graduate)

Other

Nationality: Costa Rican
Residency: US Permanent Resident
Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Fluent), French (Intermediate)

Last updated: April 17, 2026